

SkyPath — Accessibility Persona

Persona profile • Inclusive UX research synthesis • Accessible airline booking

Persona type	Accessibility-focused traveller / needs-based persona
Primary context	Traveller who may rely on assistive technology, alternative input methods, magnification, captions, clear
Core motivation	Complete a flight booking independently, confidently and without avoidable accessibility barriers
Key priorities	Predictable navigation, readable content, accessible forms, clear errors, sufficient contrast, keyboard sup
Typical behaviour	Takes more time when information is poorly structured and values interfaces that communicate state and

Persona Snapshot

This is a needs-based accessibility persona rather than a representation of one specific disability. The persona reflects travellers who may encounter barriers when digital interfaces depend heavily on visual perception, precise pointer interaction, complex navigation, unclear language or poorly communicated system states.

The accessibility need is therefore treated as a product-quality requirement rather than an edge case. A booking experience should allow users to understand available flights, enter passenger information, select services, review the booking and complete payment without unnecessary dependence on another person.

Goals

- Navigate the booking flow in a predictable sequence.
- Read and understand flight, fare and pricing information.
- Complete forms using an appropriate input method, including keyboard interaction where required.
- Understand which fields are required and how errors should be corrected.
- Identify selected seats, fares, services and other booking states clearly.
- Review the complete booking before payment.
- Access confirmation and post-booking information independently.

Behaviours & Decision Patterns

- May use screen readers, keyboard navigation, browser zoom, magnification, captions or other assistive technologies.
- Relies on meaningful labels and predictable focus or navigation order.
- Benefits from concise content hierarchy and clearly grouped information.
- Needs interactive states such as selected, unavailable, invalid and confirmed to be communicated clearly.
- May take longer to complete complex forms when controls are poorly structured.
- Values the ability to correct errors without losing previously entered information.

Accessibility Barriers / Pain Points

- Low-contrast text or controls that are difficult to distinguish.
- Information communicated through colour alone.

- Unlabelled or ambiguously labelled form fields and controls.
- Keyboard focus that is missing, unclear or moves unpredictably.
- Dense interfaces that make important information difficult to locate.
- Error messages that do not explain what went wrong or how to fix it.
- Time-sensitive interactions that do not provide adequate control.
- Interactive seat maps or selection controls that are difficult to operate with alternative input methods.
- Confirmation states that are visually obvious but poorly communicated to assistive technologies.

Needs from SkyPath

- Semantic structure and meaningful labels.
- Keyboard-accessible navigation and visible focus states.
- Sufficient colour contrast and non-colour indicators.
- Clear, concise and hierarchical content.
- Accessible form validation with actionable error messages.
- Predictable interaction patterns and consistent control placement.
- Accessible representations of selected seats, fares and optional services.
- A clear review and confirmation stage.
- Accessible post-booking information and status communication.

Design Implications

Accessibility should be considered across the entire SkyPath experience rather than added as a final visual adjustment. The persona translates into requirements for content structure, interaction design, component behaviour, form validation and system feedback.

Accessibility need	Design implication
Readable information	Use clear hierarchy, adequate text sizing, spacing and sufficient contrast.
Keyboard operation	Ensure interactive controls are reachable and usable without a pointer.
Assistive technology	Use meaningful labels, semantic structure and clear status communication.
Error recovery	Provide specific, actionable error messages and preserve entered information where possible.
Colour independence	Never rely on colour alone to communicate state, status or errors.
Complex selection	Provide accessible alternatives for visually complex interactions such as seat selection.
Predictability	Maintain consistent navigation, control placement and interaction behaviour.
User control	Avoid unnecessary time limits and allow users to review important decisions.
Confirmation	Make successful booking states and important next steps clearly perceivable.

Representative User Need

“I want to complete my booking independently, understand what is happening at every step, and never have accessibility barriers hide an important decision or prevent me from finishing the journey.”

Role in the SkyPath Design

The Accessibility Persona acts as a cross-cutting design lens for the SkyPath product. It informs information architecture, form design, interaction states, seat selection, error handling, payment, confirmation and post-booking access. The persona also supports the later accessibility considerations chapter by translating inclusive design principles into concrete interface requirements.

Validation Direction

The persona should be validated through accessibility-focused usability testing and, where possible, testing with users who rely on assistive technologies. The current persona represents design requirements and hypotheses rather than claims about the experiences of a specific participant.